

# Israa Hashem

## Contact Information

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## Education

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**Ph.D. in Economics**, Concordia University, Montréal Sep 2020 – present

Supervisors: Prof. Szilvia Pápai and Prof. Gabrielle Vasey

Dissertation: *“Essays in Education Economics and Market Design”*

**M.A. Applied Economics** (*with High Distinction*), Lebanese American University, Lebanon Sep 2018 – Jun 2020

**B.Sc. Mathematics** (*with Distinction*), Lebanese American University, Lebanon Sep 2014 – Jun 2018

**Teaching Diploma**, Lebanese American University, Lebanon Sep 2017 – Jun 2018

## Research Fields

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**Primary:** Economics of Education, Immigration Economics, Market Design

**Secondary:** Labour Economics, Economic Theory, Environmental Economics

## Working Papers

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### The Effect of School Starting Age on Academic Achievement: Evidence from British Columbia

This paper studies the causal effect of school entry age on student outcomes using administrative data on students from kindergarten through grade 12 in British Columbia, Canada. I exploit the provincial kindergarten entry cutoff date in a regression discontinuity design to identify the effect of starting school one year older. I find a positive effect on Foundation Skills Assessment (FSA) scores in grade 4, with the magnitude of the effect smaller at later grades. Work is ongoing to examine the longer-run effects on high school graduation and post-secondary outcomes.

## Transmission of Educational Outcomes: A Comparison Between Immigrant and Native Families in Canada

This paper examines how educational mobility and field-of-study preferences differ across Canadian immigrant and non-immigrant families. Using data from the Survey of Labour and Income Dynamics, I document intergenerational persistence in degree attainment and show that this persistence is weaker among children of immigrant fathers, indicating higher educational mobility for second-generation immigrants on the paternal side. I also find strong sorting into STEM fields among first-generation immigrants that does not persist in the second generation, with substantial convergence in degree choice between second-generation immigrants and the native-born population.

## Pareto-Efficient Matching with Gradual Acceptances

with Szilvia Pápai (Concordia University)

We introduce and analyze the class of Gradual Acceptance (GA) matching rules within the context of one-sided matching with priorities. GA rules extend the Immediate Acceptance rule through a step-wise selection process, slowing down the matching to allow previously rejected applicants to apply to their next highest-ranked schools before these schools are assigned. We show that all GA rules are Pareto-Efficient and satisfy basic stability and incentive properties. We also identify a subclass of Secure GA rules with especially good stability and incentive properties, revealing that stability and incentives can be jointly improved using simple selection algorithms while maintaining full efficiency.

## Publications

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Hashem, I., & Marrouch, W. (2023). Polluting resource extraction and climate risk. *Natural Resource Modeling*, 36(1), e12354. doi:10.1111/nrm.12354

## Teaching Experience

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ECON 301 – Intermediate Microeconomic Theory I    *Instructor*, Concordia University

ECON 302 – Intermediate Microeconomic Theory II    *Instructor*, Concordia University

Teaching and Research Assistant, Concordia University

Sep 2020 – present

Courses: Microeconomics, Game Theory, Industrial Organization

## Research Experience

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Research Assistant, Lebanese American University, Lebanon

Sep 2018 – Jun 2020

Research Assistant, UN Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia (UN-ESCWA), Beirut    Sep 2019 – Jan 2020

## Grants and Awards

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- Fonds de Recherche du Québec – Société et Culture (FRQSC) Doctoral Scholarship 2024–2026
- Concordia FAS Graduate Fellowship 2020–2024
- Concordia International Tuition Award of Excellence 2020–2024
- Concordia Merit Scholarship 2020–2021
- US MEPI Tomorrow’s Leaders Graduate Scholarship, Lebanon 2018
- Spirit of Service Award, Lebanese American University 2016
- USAID University Scholarship Program (Full Scholarship), Lebanon 2014

## Presentations and Seminars

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- 20th CIREQ-CIRANO Ph.D. Students’ Conference May 2026
- CIREQ Interdisciplinary PhD Conference in Applied Market Design Mar 2026
- Emergence Excellence Conference May 2025
- Concordia Graduate Student Seminar April 2025
- Econometric Society – Dynamic Structural Econometrics: Market Design Summer School  
(attended) 2023